Production deployment windows - operating guide

CURRENT 2026; effective 1 August 2026

Scope: Release engineering and application deployment sign-off. This is fictional Meridian Works guidance. The following responsibilities apply only to the named activity, not to other procedures with similar labels.

A failed deployment rehearsal cannot be bypassed by renaming the release an urgent patch; emergency approval is still required.

REL-579 records permission to use an emergency deployment window; REL-597 records a routine rehearsal result.

The coordinator records what actually happened, identifies the responsible owner and checks the applicable route. A similarly numbered form is not interchangeable with the recorded form. For a rejected submission, retain the original request and obtain corrected evidence rather than creating a replacement event.

Registry REL-680: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry REL-691: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry REL-702: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry REL-713: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

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Eligibility and operational limits. Select the named cohort and activity before applying a period or amount; different entitlements in this section are not substitutes.

Customer-visible deployments require the service owner and release lead; internal-only tool updates require the release lead.

The rollback package must be signed ninety minutes before a routine live deployment starts.

A valid request contains its underlying event date and the scope used for the calculation. Reviewers distinguish acknowledgement, completion and storage periods. A deadline for submitting evidence is not a service restoration promise. If the activity or group is not stated, escalate the question rather than borrowing a nearby rule.

Registry REL-724: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry REL-735: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry REL-746: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry REL-757: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

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Document control: this 2026 operating guide is CURRENT and effective from 1 August 2026. The 2024 edition is archived and superseded. No forecast for a later year is stated.

The release calendar in force for 2026 assigns weekday deployments to 19:00 to 21:00 UTC.

Deployment calendars authorise work. Incident communications timings remain in a separate runbook.

The reference annex has its own scope. Staff should distinguish operational permission from commercial price, evidence retention and service specifications. Publication of a code or a process owner does not create a missing technical limit or a financial guarantee.

Amendment log: this edition consolidates the current timing rule and ownership path. Historical examples remain in the archive for traceability. They are not exceptions to the current rule. A request citing an older edition must be checked against the effective document before execution.